TASK 4: SEVERITY & CASE CLASSIFICATION

Pharmacovigilance Training Exercise • Practice case analysis • 2026

Objective
Classify the adverse drug reaction (ADR) examples shown in the tutorial screenshot by seriousness and expectedness, using only the details provided.

Important scope note: This is an educational exercise based on brief examples visible in the screenshot, not a real patient report. The screenshot does not include full clinical details or the applicable product information. Where information is insufficient, this report says so rather than guessing.

1. Case summary

Case	Drug	Adverse reaction shown	Seriousness	Expectedness
01	Amoxicillin	Skin rash, itching	Cannot determine from screenshot alone; no severity or outcome details are given.	Cannot determine without checking applicable product information.
02	Ibuprofen	Gastrointestinal bleeding requiring hospitalization	**Serious** — hospitalization is explicitly stated.	Cannot determine without checking applicable product information.
03	Metformin	Lactic acidosis	Potentially serious; case-specific outcome and seriousness details are not provided.	Cannot determine without checking applicable product information.

2. Classification notes

Case 01 — Amoxicillin: The screenshot lists skin rash and itching only. There is not enough information to decide seriousness. Expectedness must be checked against the applicable product information.

Case 02 — Ibuprofen: Gastrointestinal bleeding requiring hospitalization is classified as serious because hospitalization is explicitly stated. Expectedness still requires checking the relevant product information.

Case 03 — Metformin: Lactic acidosis can be medically serious, but the screenshot provides no case-specific course or outcome. A formal assessment needs documented seriousness criteria and a check of the relevant product information.

3. Information needed for a complete assessment

- Patient/event details, onset date and outcome.
- Dose, route, treatment dates and relevant medical history.
- Whether hospitalization, a life-threatening condition, disability, or another seriousness criterion applied.
- Applicable product information to assess expectedness.

Prepared for: VirtualWorks Lab — Task 4: Severity & Case Classification

Educational practice only. This document is not a real patient report and does not replace professional assessment.